A Very Expensive Silence

Diana Lake Wellness Counseling
To: Jackson Lake Chief Executive Officer Brighthouse Industries

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Jackson,

I hope the view from the top of Brighthouse is still as clear as you like it, because from where I'm sitting, things are looking incredibly ugly.

I'm not one for dramatics—I leave that to your "visionary" press releases—but I've recently become aware of your morning rituals. It's funny, isn't it? You've spent millions on proprietary encryption and security protocols for your engineering firm, yet you couldn't keep a simple affair with a barista under wraps. Sarah, was it? From that little cafe on your commute? How tragically cliché, even for you.

I know you're currently trying to maintain the image of the "unshakeable genius" to keep the board from losing their collective minds over the stock dip. The last thing Brighthouse Industries needs is a front-page scandal involving the CEO, a subordinate's wife, and a potential "misuse of corporate resources" to fund her lifestyle.

We are separated, Jackson, but we are not divorced. My name is still tied to yours, and I have no intention of letting you drag my reputation down with your mid-life crisis.

If you want me to keep playing the part of the supportive, distant wife while you figure out how to save your failing company, the "allowance" we agreed upon needs to triple.

Immediately. Consider it a monthly subscription to my silence. If the transfer isn't in my account by the first of every month, I'm sending the photos and the hotel receipts directly to the Chronicle—and to your Board of Directors.

Don't test me on this. You might be a genius at engineering, but I'm a genius at survival.

Diana

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